The Minjok Herald

1st year, No. 2 *December 18, 1998*

School Motto

1. Let's build a promising Motherland through the education of inspiring students with national awareness.
2. Let's study for the sake of knowledge alone, not for the sake of getting ahead in the world.
3. Let's choose a career based on our talents and aptitudes, in stead of following the path for getting ahead.
4. Upon achieving these goals, I will be really happy and our Motherland will be a promising one.

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Merry Christmas!



The first snow of winter covers Dasan Hall Science Building and Cheongnyu Hall Humanities Building at KMLA

Warmth from the Past Year

by Lee Sae-rom

"One, two, three…" I'm not tired at all though I have been running around the athletic track more than five times. I feel rather light headed and tired. I dare not imagine that I could run along this big track over ten times. How hard it was to run only one time around just one year ago. The memory of the day of my fourth entrance examination suddenly occurred to me. At that time a really cold wind was freezing my hands and nose just like it is today. There was much snow around us back then too. "Well, I can enter this school in one month if I can just pass this…" We were gathering together on the playground with tense looks on our faces to run the whole distance (about four kilometers), the last barrier of the entrance exam. In front of us were students representatives from this school. "Can I run four kilometers?" With doubt and apprehension I started the run. I became short of breath running along the track after the third time. Fatigue was reducing my speed, and finally I stopped.

It was just at that moment that a senior came to me and began to speak. "Cheer up. If you stop here it will be more difficult. You had better run slowly and steadily. Try to breathe regularly. One, two, one ,two… Okay. That's much better. Now, can you continue to run?" At that time nobody knew how much I appreciated him and how he dazzled me with his warmth! I was happy and felt a special kind of relationship existed between the seniors and us newcomers. I was really happy that I could go to a school with such a warm atmosphere.

Time has passed and now I feel that I should be the one to help newcomers as that senior helped me. Even though the excitement of starting in a new school has faded, I can still look back on the past year to many happy times… making ice sculptures of princesses, the naked woman, and the ku-buk (turtle) ship on snowy days. We wrote a play, made props and performed it on stage, in English. We spent time sharing our dreams, opinions, and experiences, especially with the seniors who went to KAIST.. There were great athletic meets, dance parties, rafting trips, happy memories from our trip to Ok-kye beach, and birthday parties. Then there were the times we stayed up all night to talk with friends, to watch meteor showers and to see the World Cup Soccer games on TV.

Many happy moments from the past year flitted through my mind. The very flames that blazed up in my body I will set alight again. I'll become a kind senior, and create new experiences by sharing the warmth of my heart with newcomers and new teachers. This is the time, I think, when we should gather new energy and share our genial dispositions. It is then that, all of us can continue the marathon of school life with much less difficulty.

The Top 10 News in 1998

1. **IMF reaches KMLA** : On the last day of January, our school' s supporter Pasteur Milk almost went bankrupt. Our love towards our school shone more brightly in the darkness of IMF.
2. **The 3rd Class enters our school**: When the cute new freshmen officially become members of our school. We will become a " full" school by possessing all 1st, 2nd, and 3rd year students for the first time.
3. **The 3rd and 4th Student Councils**: For the first time the student council was elected by the students, and not according to grades.
4. **Dance Party**: After the Korean SAT, our school had its first dance party. We were all surprised by Miss Lee' s marvelous dancing skills. By the way, it was her birthday. We all had so, so much fun.
5. **Huh Dong-sung in Iceland**: Huh Dong-sung, sophomore, went to Iceland to participate in IPhO (International Physics Olympiad) and brought back a runner-up trophy.
6. **The ' Ivy Class' is founded**: From September 1st our school started a new program to get students into the top universities of America. The Ivy Class consists of 16 students.
7. **10 students are accepted into KAIST**: 10 of our sophomore students will be entering KAIST in February 1999.
8. **Back into the Humanities Building**: After almost one year of reconstruction, the Humanities building was filled with students once again. We even had a big ceremony followed by a big feast.
9. **The <Minjok Herald> is born**: On October 31, 1998 the first edition of the Minjok Herald was presented to all teachers, students, and parents. We made history.
10. **The college entrance exam**: The seven 7 seniors of KMLA took the college entrance exam on the 18th of November. We are so proud of our seniors!

Meteorites

by In Chi-won

Meteorites! A rain of falling stars! Yes. Surely, there was something falling, but if that is what someone calls a Meteorite shower, then I would say a fly is a bird. What for? What reason on earth was there to prepare for a night of Meteorites? How long were we enveloped by the fantasy of all forms of shooting stars? Why did we build up plans, keeping it secret from teachers?



It was all in vain. Anyway, we were fooled by the beautiful Ms. Park's prediction of a spectacular shower of meteorites. We went out to see the spectacle with expensive film, which we bought the previous day, with the even more expensive hope of seeing Meteorites. One o' clock… Two O' clock… Almost all the guys and gals came out to watch. Suddenly, a lone star with splendidly ornamented tail fell down from the sky. A pure hearted 1st grade girl asked me, " My Lord! Is that what they call Meteorites?"

" Are you insane.. As you can see, the word. ' Meteorites' is plural."

Three O' clock...Four O' clock… .

All the boys began to look very angry and I realized that lone star was the ' Meteorites' we had been waiting for.

At the time I wore only a ' Taekwondo' suit with no underwear, as I hung around there shuddering with the cold and humming a melody of death. I immediately started to sneak away from that dangerous place and even when I ran squarely into a wall, I couldn' t make a sound. I had to be quiet.

That was a very terrible experience. For the next time I will say, " May the meteorites come with no rumors of grandeur on night of the day of the first snow.

Korean SAT

by Lee Young-jin

The annual examination was held from 8:40 a.m. to 5:30 p.m on the 18th of November. The exam was composed of 230 questions on Korean language, foreign languages and two categories of math. 839,920 students, including 7 seniors of KMLA, took the test.

Officials in charge of preparing the exam said questions on this year's test would be easier than last year and that the average score of test takers would increase by about 10 points. But high school teachers and experts at private educational institutes predicted that the average score would be down by about 3 to 5 points as the math questions were more difficult than last year.

Government officials will notify applicants of the test results by Dec. 18. The interesting news is: the oldest taker was Hong Byong-hak, a 62 year old man, and the youngest was Lee Woo-kyong, a 13 year old boy.



"Yes. Surely, there was something falling, but if that is what someone calls a meteorite shower, then I would say a fly is a bird."

Welcome …

by Lee Dong-jae



1. Name: Dana Shin or Shin Hye Won
2. Birthday: 1974.08.28

3. Schools: Dae Won Foreign Language High School, University High School, University of Houston.

4. Overseas Experience: I lived in America after I completed my freshman year at Dae Won.

5. Height, Weight, etc.: I believe I am 165 cm and I haven't weighed myself lately. Sorry, I can't give you any information.

6. Hobbies: Drinking coffee, Listening to music, Writing Journals, Reading, Watching movies.

7. Talent: Playing the piano

8. Reason to Come Here: I've always wanted to teach and I thought teaching here would be meaningful and productive to enrich my soul.

9. Plan for the Future: Nobody knows what's going to happen tomorrow. So my philosophy is to live day by day doing my best. However, I sincerely hope that I would be more satisfied with my life as I grow older. To do that, I think I have to contribute some of my talents to the needy.

10. Other: I am very pleased to be chosen by you and the school. Although I am here to teach English, I can also deliver some life lessons that we all have to learn as human beings.

KMO

by Lee San-ha

On the 15th of November, KMO (Korean Mathematics Olympiad) was held in five universities including Hanyang University. There were 8 problems in total; four in the morning and four in the afternoon. After many universities decided to allow the Olympiad scores to be used for their entrance examinations, the popularity of KMO exploded.

Last year about 5000 students applied for the KMO, but this year the number rose to more than 8000. So, the competition rate was about 200:1. Among the 8000 students there were 10 from our school: Lee Se-young, Kang Yong-suk, Lee Min-woo, Park Eun-jin, Hong Hyun-pyo, Kim Doh-sun, Moon Chan-woong, Song Jun-hyuk, Chung Hyun-joong, and Lee San-ha. In order to prepare for the KMO, we had a special preparation period for two weeks during which time we studied very hard.

Last year, sophomore Lee Se-young, Kang Yong-suk, and Lee Min-woo took part in KMO and did extremely well on the test. Lee Se-young got a silver medal, Kang Yong-suk and Lee Min-woo got bronze medals though they were freshman at that time. They are expected to get better prizes this year.

Three Step Education

by Park Ha-shik



The distinctive difference between our school and others is the fact that a small number of students go to a teacher's office for classes. The condition where each teacher has his own office and less than 15 students study in one class room enables us to have quality education. Teachers have utilized such excellent educational environment by offering lectures that stimulate students' creativity.

Teachers of our school have tried to systemize their classes within educational scope, by taking advantage of the intimate educational relationship where teachers and students can become close.

"Three-step education will maximize students ability. ··· They will find themselves becoming professionals."

Teachers of our school do not just deliver knowledge but try to fulfill their mission to teach lessons by triggering creativity as well as spontaneity given the ideas and understanding of the subject. This is how teachers agreed to create a three-step education system (teaching, discussion, writing).



Being a leader of a society requires a person to be able to express his or her own opinions. By the same token, writing skills are critical if a person wants to leave a deep impression of his or her own thoughts and philosophies with more people.

A person can grow fully intellectual when discussion is made with logical reasons instead of emotional words. It is also important to listen for the other's point of view, since we can not only learn some new lessons but also critically pinpoint some contradicted views. Our school does not intend to nurture students who just nod and agree to everything that they read and hear.

Our school's education should place more emphasis on exploring new knowledge than on learning other's achievements and discoveries. This is the key to unlock the doors to producing Nobel prize recipients as well as creative leaders from our students, who will lead our nation and the world into a right direction.

To accomplish such education, all the teachers of our school are doing three-step education. In three-step education, teaching, discussion, and writing are simultaneously integrated into a new form of education. This new education system is still in the process of developing. However, it will be settled in no time with teachers' efforts.

Since this new educational mode in our school demands more sophisticated preparation and efforts, we all have to pay careful attention with a sense of responsibility. Otherwise, it will not prevail, and ultimately, it will fail. If things don't work out, the reasons will owe mainly to the avoidance of responsibility and fondness of comfort and easiness.

However, if both students and teachers become familiar with the three-step education, and if it becomes our school's traditional method of education, students' ability will be at its maximum and they will discover themselves becoming professionals.

(Park Ha-shik looks after the administration department of KMLA. He is one of the school's longest serving teachers.)

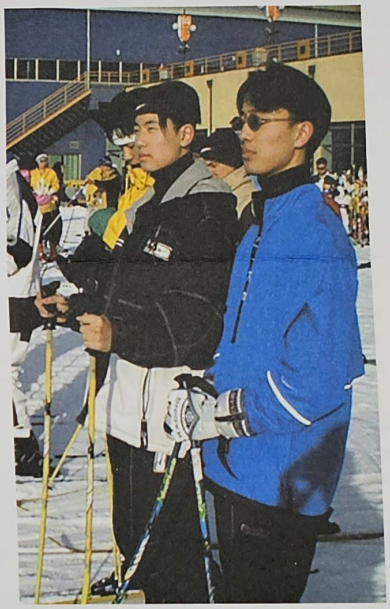
Ski Trip

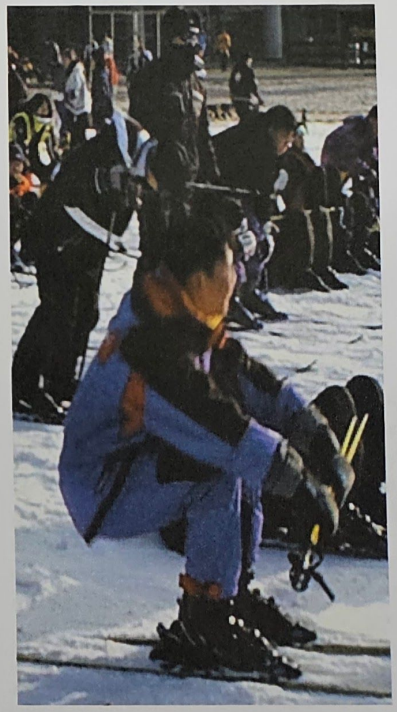
by Yoon Guk-jung

Last Sunday, all the students and some teachers of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy went skiing at Sung Woo resort for the first time this winter. Students prepared all the equipment for skiing the day before. On Sunday morning, they left the school for Sung Woo resort by school bus. It took about 30 minutes to get to the resort from the school.

They had light warming-up exercises before skiing. It seems that, because it was Sunday, there were a lot of people who came to ski. As a result, students had to wait a long time for the lifts. Furthermore, the weather was not very good; there was not much snow and it was too warm. Nevertheless, they had a lot of fun. Students enjoyed skiing for about 3 hours from 9:00 AM until 12:00 PM.

Skiing is a regular sport enjoyed by students of KMLA. In the past, ski trips were a regular winter sporting event of the school.





New Construction Plans

by Park Min-ho

Korean Minjok Leadership Academy plans to start construct on three new buildings on it's campus in Kangwon province.

Mr. Park Ha-shik, the school's administrator, said that plans have already been made with a construction company for the completion of the facilities.

In the year 2000 a twelve story apartment complex will be completed to house students who come from all over Korea. The Building will include a dining hall on the 12th floor. Special facilities will be provided for teachers and their families.

A new school building will be used as the main education center. It will be three times bigger than the existing Dasan and Chungmu buildings combined.

A new gymnasium, five times bigger than the existing sports facility, will house swimming pools and Squash courts.



The American System of Government

Throughout most of human history, most people in most countries have been slaves. The men who built the pyramids in Egypt were slaves. The men who built the Great Wall of China were slaves. Slavery was not abolished in Korea until 1899. The American system of government was established by men who were tired of all forms of slavery ? economic, political, and religious.

Of course, many of our " Founding Fathers" were slave owners, but of these quite a few saw the illogic and cruelty of slavery. It was a terrible blot on the early history of the United States of America that slavery was allowed to exist in a nation dedicated to the fundamental principle that " all men are created equal. Unfortunately, racism and the psychology of the " in group" and the " out group," of " us" versus " them," is extremely difficult for humans to overcome.

Men and women have been coming to " the new world" of the Americas for over four hundred years, seeking not only personal and family fortunes, but also seeking freedom from various forms of oppression. In every single case, the move was away from hierarchical, authoritarian structures towards greater freedom of choice and activity and lifestyle for individuals, families, and larger social groups.

Dictatorial forms of government have many titles for their rulers, but whether the absolute monarch is king or queen, emperor or empress, pharaoh or whatever, the form of government is the same ? a " top-down" structure in which one person (or perhaps a small group of people) exercise absolute authority over the greater majority of the people. The supremacy of the chief often has become so complete that he or she was regarded as an incarnation of deity.

America' s Founding Fathers realized that if the absolute ruler were loving and benevolent and exerted all his or her efforts into caring for the people, then the people would prosper, and this was often the best form of government, at least while it lasted. But if the ruler became old, senile, and incompetent, then the nature of true leadership could be corrupted or usurped by unscrupulous and self-seeking cronies. The main problem, of course, was succession: even the most benevolent king or queen could have a son or grandson who was incompetent or morally corrupt, using power for self indulgence rather than for service.

Therefore, the government of the United States is founded on the separation of powers. The Congress is the " Legislative Branch" of government and is responsible for writing and amending the laws of the nation. The President is the " Chief Executive" of the " Executive Branch," which is empowered and duty-bound to " execute" or carry out the laws. The Supreme Court has the power to declare that laws passed by the Congress are or are not consistent with the Constitution of the United States, which is, in reality, the highest law of the land.

Furthermore, there are rigorous " checks and balances" within the American system of government which are designed so that ultimate power cannot reside within any one branch of the government, which is why Americans say, rightly and proudly, that we are " a government of laws, not of men."

As I said above, the United States Constitution is the " supreme law of the land," and it cannot easily be amended or changed. From it devolve the three branches of government, one of which is the Judiciary. There are a number of judicial systems within the United States, however. Perhaps the most important is the Federal System, which decides cases first in Federal District Courts, then suitable Appellate Courts, and then, if necessary, by the Supreme Court.

In addition, each of the fifty states has its own system of laws, and powers not expressly delegated by the Constitution to the national government remain within the power of the individual states to decide. Thus, the laws on the buying and selling of property; the creation and running of businesses; marriage, divorce, and family law; and even the criminal laws and penalties for such acts as theft, arson, rape, and murder may vary from state to state.

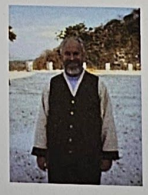
Furthermore, within each state, there are counties, municipalities, towns, and villages, which can also enact and enforce laws, such as traffic ordinances and parking tickets, so long as these laws do not conflict or interfere with the orderly functioning of the larger entities.

At every level ? from village to town to city to county to state to nation ? wherever there are laws, there are courts. America' s Founding Fathers realized that, historically, the courts ? including the judges and prosecutors ? were often controlled by political or ecclesiastical leaders, " bought" by those with money, or " influenced" by those with power. This is one reason for the separation of powers and for the " trial by jury" system, rather than having trials presided over only by judges.

The United States of America came into being on July 4, 1776, through the " Declaration of Independence" from England. Thus, our government is now over 222 years old. It has the same Constitution and the same form of government now as it did at the beginning. Therefore, we Americans are rightfully proud that we are one of the oldest systems of government in the modern world!

"... so that we may together forge a system in which the whole and the part can function harmoniously."

Our forefathers predicted and prayed that America would be " a city set upon a hill," so that our model and example could be followed by others, insofar as they found it successful, and changed for the better in whatever ways they found it wanting. Therefore, let us jointly resolve to overcome the bounds and strictures, the narrowness and prejudices of race, gender, nation, and even religion, so that we may together forge a system in which the whole and the part can function harmoniously, so that all can optimize their life, liberty, and pursuit of happiness.



The Merit of the Minjok Court

by Kim Jin-soo

Have you ever heard of 'Shinmungo'? It was a name of a bell in Chosun that people rang when they felt they were falsely charged with an offense. Hearing the sound of the bell, the king held court and listened to what the accused had to say. And then, if their testimony is regarded truthful, the king would try to solve the problem as fairly as he could. There is such a system as this in our school: the student's court.

Living in a school, there are many rules to follow. When these rules are broken, it is not done on purpose There is nothing we can do to prevent these things. However, we still are given punishments.

This is definitely unfair treatment. To consider such situations, every second Sunday our school holds an open (law) court. In the court, students can explain their situation and, either defend themselves or ask to be represented by a student-lawyer. Then, the judge rules on the case and, if required, sentences the defendants with punishments to fit their violations. After the court, convicted students are given "the punishment".

"The punishment" consists of students having to raise their hands over their heads while standing on the front step of the main school building. It is actually not a punishment, but a warning that just tells them "Be careful next time."

In this system, most students accept the judgment with almost no argument, because they get a chance to have their complaints heard. As a result, we can enjoy our school life much more cheerfully and happily.

Editorial On Current Events

KMLA ··· Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. One of the reasons we came to this school is to become leaders – leaders of our country, leaders of the world. One of the most important things a great leader must have is their own outlook on the world. They must have a solid understanding and firm view to overcome the many difficulties they will face as leaders

To establish a strong and sturdy view towards the world, knowing the world is definitely an essential thing. If you want to know about the world, the best way is to continually watch the news, read newspapers and magazines. You must see for yourself how the world is changing. Why is this happening? What are the causes? How do the governments react? How efficient is the plan? Etc.

Developing your own view towards the world is not something you can do in a short period of time. Many, many years of observation and thought are required.

"Take a memorable quotation from this article (a pullquote) to pique your readers' interest."

On December fifth, four of our KMLA students participated in Quiz Champion, a quiz show hosted by the Arirang Broadcasting Station. Our students played a one-sided game, out performing the competition, until the section on current news/common knowledge questions was introduced. It soon became obvious that our school's students lacked knowledge in that field, compared to the other school's students. Why?

In our school we do not, cannot watch TV except at mealtimes where only CNN is allowed. Frankly, most students cannot fully understand the CNN English News, so the majority of students do not pay any attention to the TV. As a result, KMLA students do not watch the news. Some students read the newspaper and magazines but the tight schedule restricts most students from doing so. So the future leaders of Korea do not know what is happening in the world today. Nowadays the world changes so quickly that you must be wide-eyed to catch all the changes.

KMLA students must find a way to get informed about things that are occurring in the world. Also, interrelating with the world outside our school is necessary. To establish a strong view on the world and to look at the world from a wider point of view, it is essential that students continually be aware of the news.

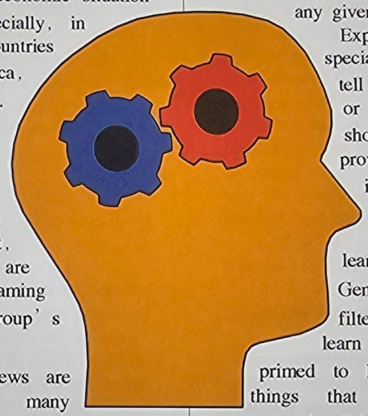
Anti-Semitism

by Kim Sun

According to a 1998 survey by Marttila Communications Group and the Boston-based opinion research firm of Kiley & Company Anti – Semitism in America has dropped to 12% in 1992. There can be many reasons for this.

First, more people were educated than before. Education makes people think more reasonably and logically. In previous days, people usually were driven by their emotions, so if there were conflicts with Jewish people, they easily gave their consent to the people who abhorred the Jews.

Second, the economic situation is much better, especially, in western developed countries such as America, England, and France. With prosperous conditions most people can escape hunger which they have suffered from in the past. As a result, most normal people are not concerned with blaming rich Jews for their group's deprivation.



Third, the Jews are very influential in many spheres like the economy, science, and politics, especially in America. Most upper-class are Jews of Anglo-Saxon decent. It is the invisible hand of Jews that controls America substantially. But as you know, America is the most powerful country in the world now. Therefore, Jews become so strong that people dare not to show their Anti-Semitism.

I have thought about the third reason deeply. To me, one should have power and not have to be blamed by others for things they are not responsible for. This seems the natural law of human society. But let's assume this: If someone eager to be strong may try to get power even though his way is wrong. What will happen if everybody does this? Huge conflicts in human history, have been over fights for power. We should realize that it makes us more miserable instead. Maybe it is a limitation of humans.

Experimental Learning

by Jeong Ju-hyun

The human brain has a marvelous capacity for picking up information. Think for a moment about the last time you did something exciting. You will probably notice that you remember the incident very clearly. Which just goes to show that we do have the ability for one hit learning.

However, providing information in a linear format (as in a book, or in a standard classroom setting) can actually hamper the brain's ability to learn. The brain prefers much richer input and tends to filter information, taking that which is most pertinent at any given moment.

Experiential learning is special in that it does not tell people what to think, or what content they should learn. Rather, it provides rich and interesting experiences. As people participate in these experiences they learn a great many things. Generally, because of the filtering effect, they will learn most of what they are primed to learn. Some will learn things that the course designer targeted. Others will learn points and gain insights unique to their interests.

Experiential learning is very different from traditional learning. The teacher no longer " teaches" , but is charged with creating an environment in which learning can happen. His or her role is to facilitate the learning process. Participants look to the "teacher" to guide the process while they take responsibility for learning what is most relevant to them.

Simulations provide an excellent way of creating learning experiences. However, all learning can be done experientially. Simply getting people to stop an activity and notice their own physiological and psychological state can be enough to create a powerful learning experience. The key to effective experiential learning is to begin focusing people on what happens around them and inside them, getting them to take personal responsibility for observation and the identification of patterns in the environment.

Against the Court

by Song Joon-hyuck

There is a saying that goes " The law is the minimum of ethics." This also means that, as a social animal, we, at least, have to keep the law. But we cannot tell exactly if the crime or fault is a step too far over the line between law and ethics. Even the public, who doesn't allow anything irrational, consider such situations as a human being.

In our school, beginning this year, the student court has been organized for student. By defending and explaining about their breaking the rules, we can diminish our punishment according to the judges' decision. The purpose is really good, but I think the student court in our school has some problems.

The judges and prosecutors are not fully qualified to judge the students' offenses; they hardly consider the situation objectively. In our school, which is a boarding school, school life itself is our common life, so we can easily forget something, or be late for schedule by mistake. In this situation can we exactly classify kinds of trifling things? I think it's impossible.

And then the more serious problem is lifting our arms on Sunday for hours according to the points. For us Sunday is very precious time, our only free time in a week. To spend that getting punishment is a very unproductive, wasteful time. I think cleaning somewhere or studying in napping time is a more productive idea for students & teachers.

So far I've talked about student court and what kind of problems they have. It's not only my opinion, but most of the students agree. If the committee knew that, they'd have to consider their policy, because the policy was made for the students in the first place.

Black/Japanese Descendants of Tan-Gun?

by Carlton Johnson

What is the **purpose** of Life? Do we have **one** chance at it (typical Western thinking); or **many** chances (as in "reincarnation," typical Eastern thinking)?

In fact, **is** there **life after death**, or simply **non-being**?

What is the relationship between the **"Tae Han"** (as in "Tae Han Saram, Tae Han uro") and the **"Ingan"** (as in "Hong-Ik Ingan")?

What does the **Mahabharata** have to do with the Korean Minjok spirit andre-unification of North and South Korea?

Can **religion** contribute to the **peaceful resolution of human conflicts** arising in many parts of the world?

The next time you sit down to a meal ask one of the sophomore, KAIST initiates about one of these questions; and you will probably get an ear-full, and discover a little bit more about who you are, yourself. These questions were a few of the topics that we discussed in the **"Social Anthropology"** class that the KAIST-bound students invited me to teach. Once you have given yourself time to draw your own conclusions on these issues, you may find, on my homepages, some of my own answers; as well as some perspectives of others with whom I happen to agree:

http://www.geocities.com/CollegePark/Quad/1957/

http://www.freeyellow.com/members2/more-shimjung/familinks.html

Many of these questions are related to a certain quote from our chairman, Mr. Choi; words which appeared in the first issue of the ***Minjok Herald***:

... it is possible for the superpowers to invade and rule any nation in the world, not by armed forces as in the past, but with their culture or economy. Then it is easily foreseen that any nation can become the slave of political, economic superpowers unless it has *a strong ethnic* identity....

Chairman Choi Myoung-jae

In our classes, we came to understand (I hope) that the essence of Social Anthropology is related to this search for **"Identity"** -- one's individual identity; as well as our global/universal identity. Know thyself! ... the origins of you; the **historical "I"**.

After all, **"I"** am the **fruit** of human history. And what, actually, is history (or her-story)? Where does it begin, really? With Tan Gun? What will constitute its "consummation?"

Some Koreans, I hear, think of Christianity as 'the White man's religion.' And many exploited peoples around the world have recognized little more in this 'faith' than an exploitive ideology which served (serves) as a precursor to imperialistic, Western 'commonwealths'... In growing up a Black Christian in an apartheid America, I came to struggle with this same indictment of Christianity...

Social Anthropology, fortunately, gave me the skills and breadth of vision to suspend judgment on any people or ideology long enough to appreciate the context of that 'other' reality in 'the grand scheme of things.' The methodology of Social Anthropology is known as **"Participant Observation"**: the means of gathering data to validate one's hypotheses on the nature of a group, by way of direct contact or through primary sources. This process reduces the filtering of history and values through the typically, biased, ethnocentric viewpoints which has so dominated 'Western' scholarship, to date. My own battle cry became: "To what **extent** is something **true** or false?"

One jewel which this freedom has afforded me is my beloved nuclear family; my wonderful wife and three rambunctious boys. Thanks to the objectivity Social Anthropology demands, I was able to suspend judgment on the very controversial Korean adventurer--Moon Sun-Myung--just long enough to participate in a matching and observe how he manages to sensitize the heart strings of virtual enemy out-groups; so that they joyfully and willingly marry, to make an international family.

As difficult as Koreans might find a marriage between Korean and Japanese spouses; I dare say that the joining of Blacks and Whites, in America, is even more daunting a challenge. How can anyone, (Korean or whatever nationality), tear down those walls of hatred and chauvinism? Certainly it cannot be done without incurring the wrath of ethnocentric minds.

Social Anthropology strives for detailing the total spectrum of the Human cultural experience, individually; in order to draw some conclusions about the universal nature of Man as a social being, globally.

And so, as Hellenism and Hebraism are strains that run deep in our mutual Western identity, Confucius thought and Buddhism greatly flavors our mutual Eastern sensitivities. While the Judeo-Christian and Islamic cultural spheres see in the seed of Abraham God's promise: to bless all the world; the seed of Tan-Gun, on the other hand, emerges out of Korea, with a similar potential: Hong-Ik Ingan.

Will the new Korean **identity** recognize the prolific dispersion of the seed of Tan-Gun far afield, apart from the pedigree known, here, as Tae Han?

Indeed my children--Black and Japanese, now merging with Korean language and thought--shall manifest their roots in Tan Gun; as well as their blessing in the promise of Abraham. The Homeostasis of our planet requires, now more than ever, our common recognition of our mutual, constitutional position in the uni-verse.

Korea should deeply identify with the ***goodness*** and the hope of the Tan-Gun legend; and become a people who can consummate and propagate the ***goodness*** of the ideal of Hong-Ik Ingan. If Korea rises to hold the **goodness** of these ideals, in trust, for all of humanity (Ingan), then she will surely be welcomed as a leading nation, the world over.

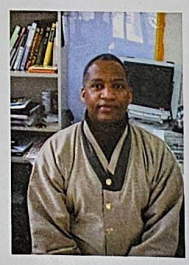
"If Korea rises to hold the goodness of these ideals, in trust, for all of humanity, then she will be welcomed as a leading nation."

Every morning, before breakfast, our small family gathers for "Hon-jung Shin-sung" (sp); to renew our commitment to pursue God's hope for His 'Kingdom on earth.' (Ewha Segye ?) One of our affirmations states: **"Our family pledges to seek our original homeland and establish the original ideal of creation, the Kingdom of God on Earth and in Heaven, by centering on True Love."**

http://www.freeyellow.com/members2/more-shimjung/familinks.html

Our love for this land and for these ideals reveal a deep spiritual affinity to Korea--if not a lineal thread--drawing us to help establish that original, ideal, universal homeland here, in Korea. We are grateful to be here; to be touching the hearts and souls of future leaders of a global homeland. Replies welcome:

(E-mail add. on page 10)



Exam Aftermath

by Kim Sang-kyun

Now that the university entrance exam is over, there is a plenty of free time for us seniors. At last I have time to read and think.

When I was a freshman, two years ago, I didn't have a watch. My life was not controlled by time. After night studies, I would walked up to the dormitory alone and had some time for myself. I called this my free time. It was when I could think deeply about my future, my school, and my friends.

After sometime, maybe the second semester of my sophomore year, I bought a watch. From then, time has restrained my life like the watch restrained my wrist. I was driven around by time. Without my watch, I couldn't do anything, and I lost my free time.

Let's recover our free time. If there is always some free time in our everyday life we can look back on the things we did for the day.

Let's recover our free time, and take the time to look around ourselves. There are many friends around us. They are like flowers just needing a bit more water and sunlight to bloom. If you hurry all the time and let yourself be controlled by time the flower will wither.

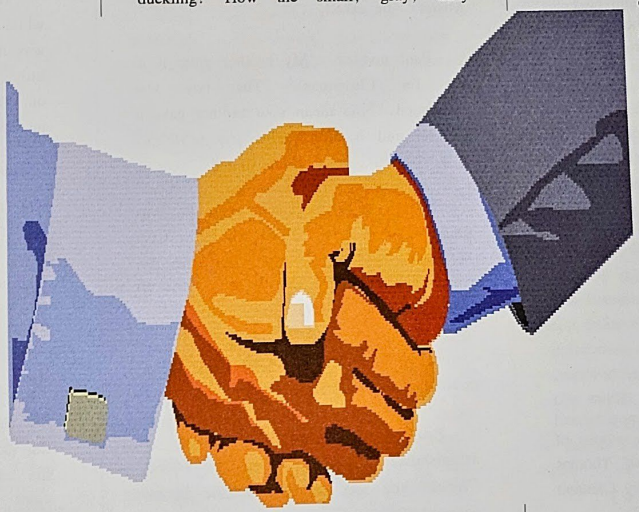
"Free time" helps me remember the care the flower needs, then surely the flower will bloom into a beautiful friendship.

I do not want anyone to mistake this free time for time you can waste. To find the real merit of this free time you must work to get it. Free time and wasting time are two different things. I am sure every one of our school's students can achieve this "free time" with just a little effort.

I See a Swan

by Jeong Ju-hyuck

This past Chusok, I was at my grandparents' house watching TV. Reporters were interviewing an old woman. I could see, just by looking at her face, all the suffering she had endured... so many wrinkles, so many and so deep. There were tears flowing down her cheeks. "I know that there is not much time for me to live, but I have one wish before I close my eyes." She was sobbing. "If I could just take a look at my family... oh, I miss them so much." Her family had been scattered during the Korean War.



"As the swan glides through the sky all the pain will be replaced with joy, all the tears with laughter, and all the hatred with and peace."

It is a real tragedy that our country is divided into two. I don't know how long it will be, but all the years that Korea is two will forever be a painful history that will remain in every Korean's heart.

I believe that now, the period of division, is a stage of learning and growing; learning how much pain there is in being divided; learning how much we love each other and how much we love our nation. I strongly believe that there is a purpose to this division, to this suffering, to this struggle. This is just a process in becoming a powerful nation

Do you know the story of the ugly duckling? How the small, gray, dirty duckling, hated by everyone else, grew up to be a beautiful white swan? Well, I think our country is that very ugly duckling. Divided into two, hating and killing our own people, the war, the political difficulties, the economic crisis, all the suffering ... all the tears, all the pain. But the thing is, someday we will become a swan, a powerful nation. When I say the word "powerful", I do not mean it as in a lion or a bear. What I'm talking about is the "power" one can feel just by looking at the swan flying through the blue sky in all its grace, beauty, and dignity, it's wings stretched out in full length moving up and down smoothly and slowly, causing a small current in the air; power within grace; power within beauty.

As the swan glides through the sky all the pain will be replaced with joy, all the tears with laughter, and all the hatred with and peace.

I see an old woman, maybe the woman I saw on TV, living so happily with her family ... with a smile blooming across her face that would melt everyone's heart.

I see a country where people care for each other as if they were one big family, filled with love in their hearts.

I see a nation above all nations of the world, a peaceful place, exciting, ... wonderful.

I see a swan, white and beautiful, gracefully gliding through the blue sky.

Yoon Bong-gil

by Lee Sung-ho

Why did Moses, a prince in Egypt, kill an Egyptian task master for abusing his people? Torn by a similar pain, the young Yoon Bong-Gil became a Korean Independence activist. As Korea was suffering under Japan's malicious oppression, Yoon Bong-Gil fatefully dedicated his life for the independence of our nation. In fact, before mortally striking one vicious general of the Japanese militia, he pledged to abandon his life in order to avenge his fatherland.

Until about 50 years ago, Japan subdued Korea and treated her most wickedly during 40 bitter years of occupation. To supplement their own war aims in the Asian arena, they exploited Korea and all her natural resources, taking – without thought of repayment – whatever they pleased. Moreover, they abducted Korean virgins to "comfort" the sexual desire of their fellow Japanese soldiers. Some of the detestable things, which Japan did in Korea, were so cruelly beyond any people's imagination, that many Koreans, Yoon Bong-Gil included, could not hold their peace.

The young Bong-Gil was born in a small country town. In fact, he was just an ordinary boy in his adolescence. However, when he turned 25 years old, the March 1 Demonstration occurred. This momentous, nationwide awakening was the largest demonstration of that era against Japan's hideous oppression. To break the spirit of this movement, vindictive Japanese soldiers killed many worthy Korean citizens. This unjustified aggression stimulated Yoon Bong-Gil to become an independence activist, himself. Therefore, he left his home for the city of Shang-hai, in China. There, he heard news that the a Japanese general was coming. Finally, at the risk of his life, he made a resolution to assassinate this general. It must have been obvious that he would be caught by the Japanese army after such a reckless attack. Nevertheless, he unflinchingly carried forward his plan. Fortunately for his cause, he succeeded in killing the general; by hurling a small bomb at him. But, unfortunately for him, as he had predicted earlier, he was arrested and executed.

In order to accomplish his goal and avenge the countless innocent, he resolutely gave up his life. Remarkably, he was only 26 years old when he died. Moreover, his was no ordinary goal, as other people might challenge. Usually, we set goals for our own, individual success. Bong-Gil's goal, however, was for the benefit of the whole nation of Korea; even though the sacrifice of life was required to achieve his purpose. He was, indeed, a real hero; more concerned for the destiny of his homeland than for himself.

Actually, when I read this story, I felt somewhat ashamed of myself. He threw away his life to save the country, without any hesitation, while, in contrast, I have only concentrated on my personal success. His biography has truly inspired me. From his example, I have learned more clearly the meaning of real courage.

Santa Claus

Santa Claus - A legendary figure who, supposedly, brings presents to children on Christmas Eve.

Santa Claus is an American adaptation of European traditions concerning Saint Nicholas. These were introduced into America by the Dutch settlers in New Amsterdam. The name Santa Claus is a contraction of the Dutch Saint Nilolas (Sinter Klaas). In the United States, Saint Nicholas became associated with Christmas rather than December 6, his traditional feast day, and he developed into a purely secular figure.

Most of the central features of the Santa Claus legend, such as his climb down the chimney, and the switches he leaves for naughty children, are of Dutch origin. His red suit trimmed with white fur originated in the bishop's miter and cape worn by the Dutch saint. His association with reindeer and the North Pole, however, apparently came from Scandinavia. These and other attributes of Santa Claus were popularized during the 19th century through the stories of Washington Irving, the cartoons of Thomas Nast, and the famous 1822 poem by Clement Moore, "A Visit from Saint Nicholas."

Male and female European counterparts of Santa Claus include the English Father Christmas, the German Kris Kringle, the Italian Befana, and Russia's grandmotherly Babouschka. He is also known as Father Christmas in England, Grandfather Frost in Russia, Pere Noel in France and Saint Nick in the United States. Many of them have been influenced by the American conception of the figure.

A Brother Like That

A friend of mine named Paul received an automobile from his brother as a Christmas present. On Christmas Eve when Paul came out of his office, a street urchin was walking around the shiny new car, admiring it. "Is this your car, Mister?" he asked.

Paul nodded. "My brother gave it to me for Christmas." The boy was astounded. "you mean your brother gave it to you and it didn't cost you anything? Boy, I wish . . ." He hesitated.

Of course Paul knew what he was going to wish for. He was going to wish he had a brother like that. But what the lad said jarred Paul all the way down to his heels.

"I wish," the boy went on, "that I could be a brother like that."

Paul looked at the boy in astonishment, then impulsively he added. "Would you like to take a ride in my automobile?"

"Oh yes, I'd love that."

After a short ride, the boy turned and with his eyes aglow, said, "Mister, Would you mind driving in front of my house?"

Paul smiled a little. He thought he knew what the lad wanted. He wanted the show his neighbors that he could ride home in a big automobile. But Paul was wrong again. "Will you stop where those two steps are?" the boy asked.

He ran up the steps. Then in a little while Paul heard him coming back, but he was not coming fast. He was carrying his little crippled brother. He sat him down on the bottom step, then sort of squeezed up against him and pointed to the car.

"There she is, buddy, just like I told you upstairs. His brother gave it to him for Christmas and it didn't cost him a cent. And some day I'm gonna give you one just like it . . . Then you can see for yourself all the pretty things in the Christmas windows that I've been trying to tell you about."

Paul got out and lifted the lad to the front seat of his car. The shining-eyed older brother climbed in beside him and the three of them began a memorable holiday ride.

That Christmas Eve, Paul learned what Jesus meant when he had said: "it is more blessed to give . . ." from Chicken Soup for the Christian Soul.



Limericks

Claus

There was an old fellow named Claus

With a case of the mid-winter blahs.

Taught his reindeer to fly

So they took to the sky.

The taps on your roof may be paws.

Smiley Scrooge

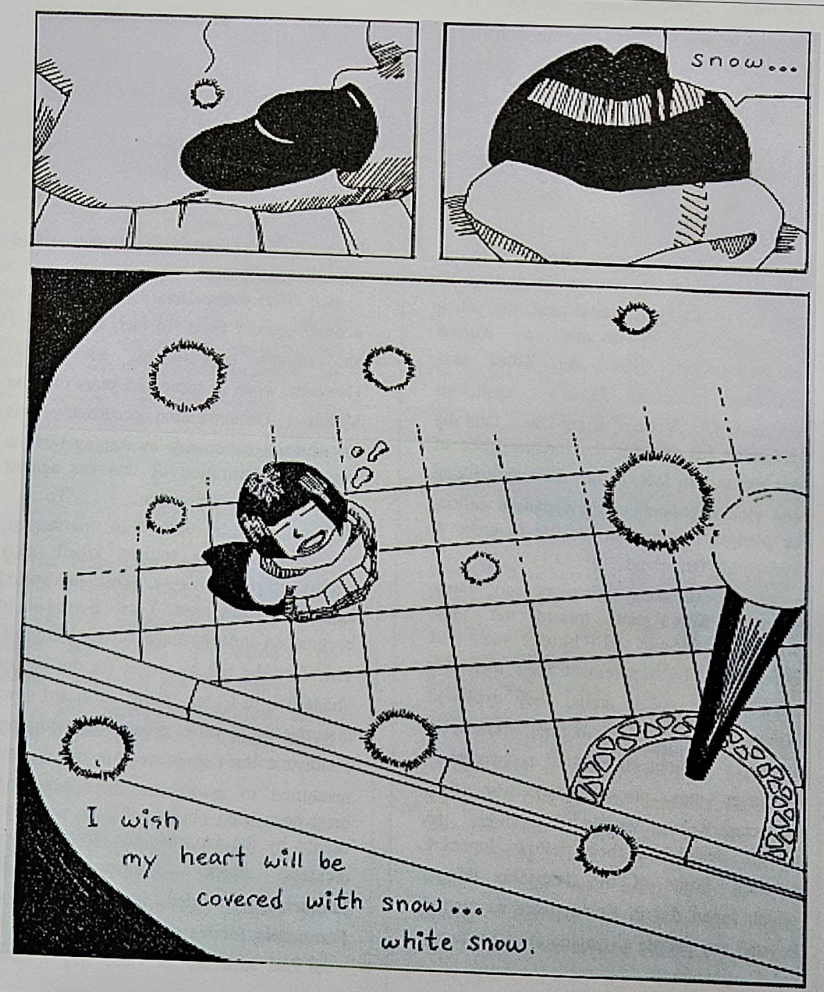
Old Scrooge wore a smile not a sneer

And was filled with the holiday cheer.

For there in the sky,

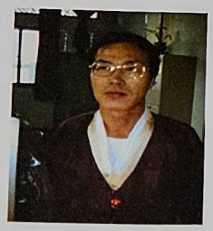
He saw flying by

St. Nick and his eight brave reindeer.



A Sleepy Tale

by Park Yoon-sang



Twenty-five years ago, in November of 1973, the senior year in high school was just as difficult as it is now, due to great pressure and too much studying. The curriculum began at 4:30 am and ended at 10:30 PM with very little time to spare. Obviously, the students suffered continuously from lack of sleep.

One day, during English class right after lunch time my classmates and I were working on the previous year's Seoul University English Entrance Exam to prepare for the upcoming exam. The teacher asked K (to protect his identity), who was fairly good at English, to read and translate an English passage. However, K only stared at the paper and did not respond at all. The teacher couldn't wait any longer. He went close to K and put his hand on K's shoulder saying. "Hey! I said read and translate it!?"

> " *I realize I was almost naked; and because it was still dinnertime, there was a crowd in the corridor just outside my room* "

Then K pushed the hand off his shoulder in disgust saying, "You stupid man. Stop doing that. I'll get in deep trouble if I get caught!"

The teacher finally realized that K was sleeping with his eyes open.

Sure enough, K got in deep trouble and was yelled at. severely. Not only that, but the English teacher got in the habit of checking to see whether K was sleeping in class by waving his hand in front of K's face. From then on, all the other students tried very hard to learn open-eye sleeping like K, but no one ever succeeded.

From Wingee

My dear students,

Time seems to pass more quickly than Minjok students can gobble down their meal. One year has come and fled. What have I taught you? I hope you have learned that watching a sunset can be just as much a part of education as sitting and absorbing facts in the classroom. As well as acquiring information, equip yourself to deal with real life outside the classroom and prepare to meet the challenges of the world.

Take the initiative and responsibility to learn. Discover the fulfillment of life-long learning. Never stop learning even beyond university.

What have I taught you? In your pursuit to succeed in your studies, do not forget to rest and reflect. Above all else, do not forget to love others.

What have I taught you? Or is it perhaps more appropriate to ask, have I learned from you? I made the Ivy freshmen write about what they have learned in their life. Since it' s my philosophy that good teachers should be good learners, and since I vowed never to make students do what I wouldn' t do myself, I have also written about what I have learned.

What have I learned in my year at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy? I have learned that I should bow, not wave when greeting the chairman. I have learned to expect all school visitors to ask, " You are a freshmen, aren' t you?" in Korean of course. I have heard this phrase so often, I can recognize it in my sleep.

I have learned that in Korea, I must always be prepared to explain how I am Canadian. " But you don' t look Canadian?" Does anyone know what a Canadian should look like?

I have witnessed that homemade cookies and squares can disappear faster than Ju-hyun can rattle off a tongue twister. I have learned that students who feign understanding can actually be totally in the dark.

I have learned that adolescents' moods and energy levels frequently change, almost as frequently as the class timetable. I have learned that the animal farm, or should I say " zoo" , makes for an interesting class: I had a mouse, a turtle, even a dinosaur, and don' t forget that there are many fish in the sea. You heard this straight from the horse' s mouth. I have learned that with Hyun-joong in your class, anything goes.

I have learned that it wasn' t difficult to spot the students' creativity. I just had to listen to the excuses made in order to avoid punishment.

I have learned what causes the greatest stir in class: just state that you don' t want to get married. Along these lines, I have also learned what elicits the greatest attention in class: talk about your ex-boyfriend.

I have learned that being a senior in Korea means pasting the books to your head. Life? What life?

I have learned from Mr. Murphy that when I visit Mexico, I should take Min-jae with me. I have learned not to take a picture of toilet paper every time I see some in a restaurant.

I have learned that it' s an adventure to follow Il-hwan up the ski lift. Let' s do it again! I have learned that Sang-kyoon makes good use of his opportunities when Eun-jin' s on lunch duty.

I have learned to live with the constant query, Miss Lee, Where' s your rice? I have learned that the support and appreciation of the students' parents is very uplifting.

I have realized that Minjok students are extremely precious to me. I have and will always delight in each and every student' s presence. I feel like I have been torn from my children.

Je vous aime. Au revoir mes enfants.

Wingee

Minjok Dorm Life: In a Man's World!

by Choi Jung-min

Everyone has a favorite place.

Personally, I just like to be alone with no one to bother me, to tease me, no one to watch me. This is what we call "solitude" and "freedom". But there is one thing I feel is a necessity, that I must have with me in my own special place – music. Any favorite place should allow me to listen to music at liberty. Therefore, I can say that my favorite place is anywhere I can be alone with music. For example, my dorm is one of the best places in the world for me. My room in the boys' dorm is located on the first floor and is one of the rooms nearest the cafeteria. So, it is very comfortable for me.

Normally, in the dorm, my favorite place, I am almost naked. I just strip down to my under pants and let it all hang out, so to speak. I generally prefer to be comfortable, "au naturelle," without any clothes. At first, my roommates could not understand me, but now they have gotten used to me, and have learned to accept my ways. Now my fellow sophomores, seniors, and all the boy students understand me.

But something happened the other day that left me in an uncomfortable and awkward position. Just after dinnertime, I was sharing my sponge cake with some seniors and my fellow sophomores. After finishing the dessert, I stood up to throw away the wrapper. I grabbed the garbage and opened the door. Beside my room, there is a trash can. I took a step towards the trash can.

At that time, I realized I was almost naked; and because it was still dinnertime, there was a crowd in the corridor just outside my room. I was very surprised. I turned back in a blink of an eye, and hid behind the wall. Fortunately, no one could see me directly. I took a breath. 'Huuh!.

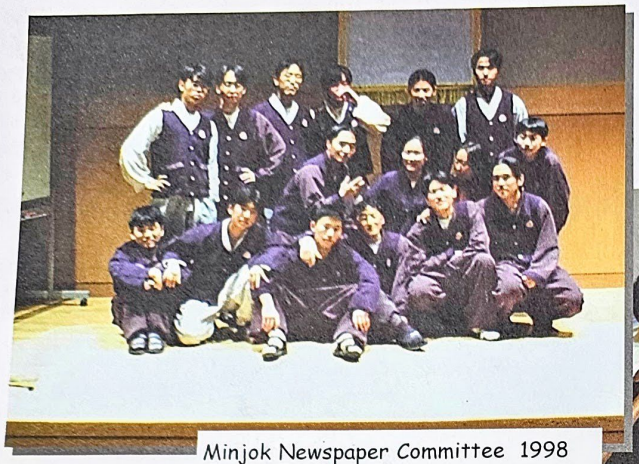
Then, I looked around me and to my surprise, my eyes met the strong glare of a girl who was standing in front of the dorm entrance. Her eyes were fixed on me, watching me.

"Oh, My goodness!"

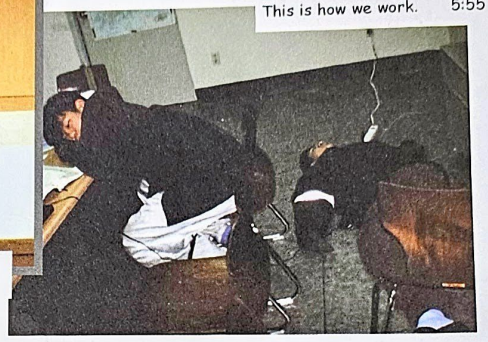
Suddenly, my safe haven didn't seem so safe anymore. That my favorite place had been violated like this, was terrible!

I stood there feeling exposed and thinking 'Please, get me out of here!!! I guess you can never feel too safe, no matter where you are.

The Minjok Herald ...



Minjok Newspaper Committee 1998



This is how we work. 5:55 AM

This is the second edition of the Minjok Herald. Last time we barely made the deadline and it was really hard doing all the work in just a few days.

So we made up our mind that this time we would not wait until the last minute. But guess what? The same thing happened.

But from this edition we decided that the newspaper should have a big theme, that all the articles should be in some way related to each other, that is, pointing to the same direction, and not just a listing of all the things that occurred in school.

It wasn't an easy task at all for us, inexperienced Minjok Herald staff. But thanks to all staff members, teachers, friends, the 2nd edition of the Minjok Herald has finally just ended, it's finishing touches complete. I again sincerely thank these people and am extremely happy to see the success of the 2nd edition.

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